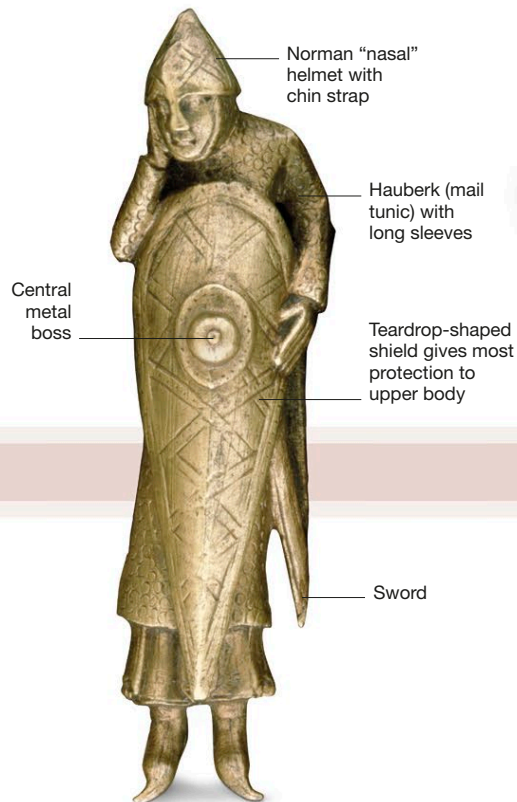
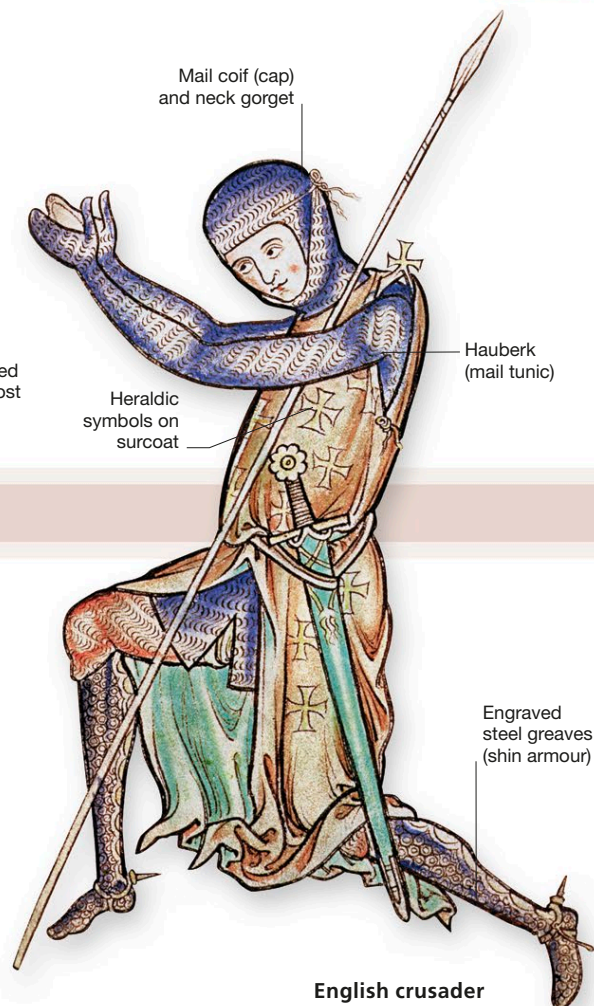




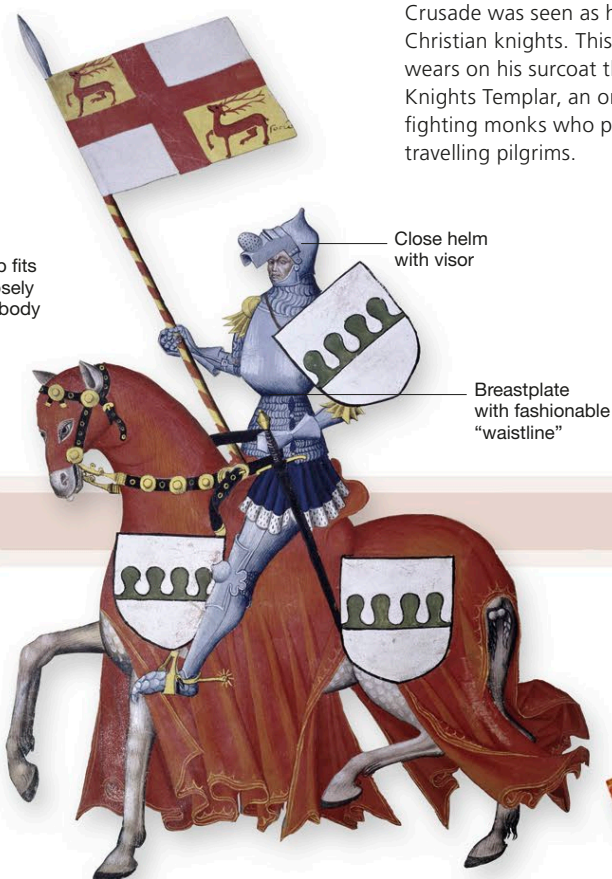
English or German soldier This soldier wears a hauberk (a calf-length mail tunic). Underneath, he is dressed in a fashionable long tunic and pointed shoes. The shield covers most of the body and has a metal boss to deflect blows.



English crusader Undertaking a Crusade was seen as holy work for Christian knights. This figure, c.1250, wears on his surcoat the cross of the Knights Templar, an order of elite fighting monks who protected travelling pilgrims.



Quilted clothing In the 14th century thick, quilted or stuffed clothing, as in this reconstruction, was worn under mail and plate armour to buffer the body against the metal, distribute weight, and cushion blows.

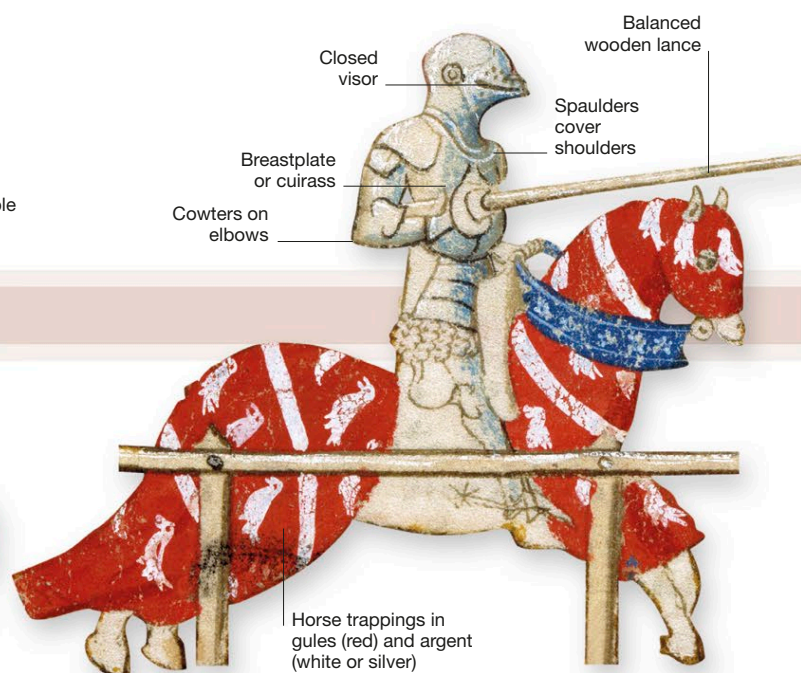


Medieval tournament A man fighting on horseback needed different armour from a foot soldier. Full plate armour had to protect the whole body but be light and flexible enough to allow the rider to mount his horse unaided.

HERALDRY



Heraldry began as a means of identification in battle. It combined tinctures (colours) with charges (symbols) to make individual patterns used on shields, armour, banners, hangings, and crests. A precise language describes these "blazons", and emblems could represent a quality or virtue: Geoffrey of Anjou (d.1151) carries a shield with the charge "Azure (blue), four lions rampant Or (gold)".



French mail and plate armour All the individual pieces of armour making up a suit of mid-15th-century plate were tied to a fitted and padded arming doublet, using laces attached to the doublet. Knights dressed from the legs upwards.